



UNIVERSIDAD TECNICA FEDERICO SANTA MARIA

Tesis de Magister

Design and Sizing of an Energy Storage System for a Hybrid Tugboat

Tesis para optar al título de
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Capítulo 1

Introduction

1.1. Motivation and Background

The growing global concern over climate change has significantly pressured industries to adopt sustainable practices. The maritime sector, responsible for approximately 2.5 % of energy sector CO₂ emissions, has continuously increased its emissions, as shown in Fig. 1.

<https://theroundup.org/co2-greenhouse-gas-emission-statistics/>

<https://www.container-xchange.com/blog/shipping-emissions/>

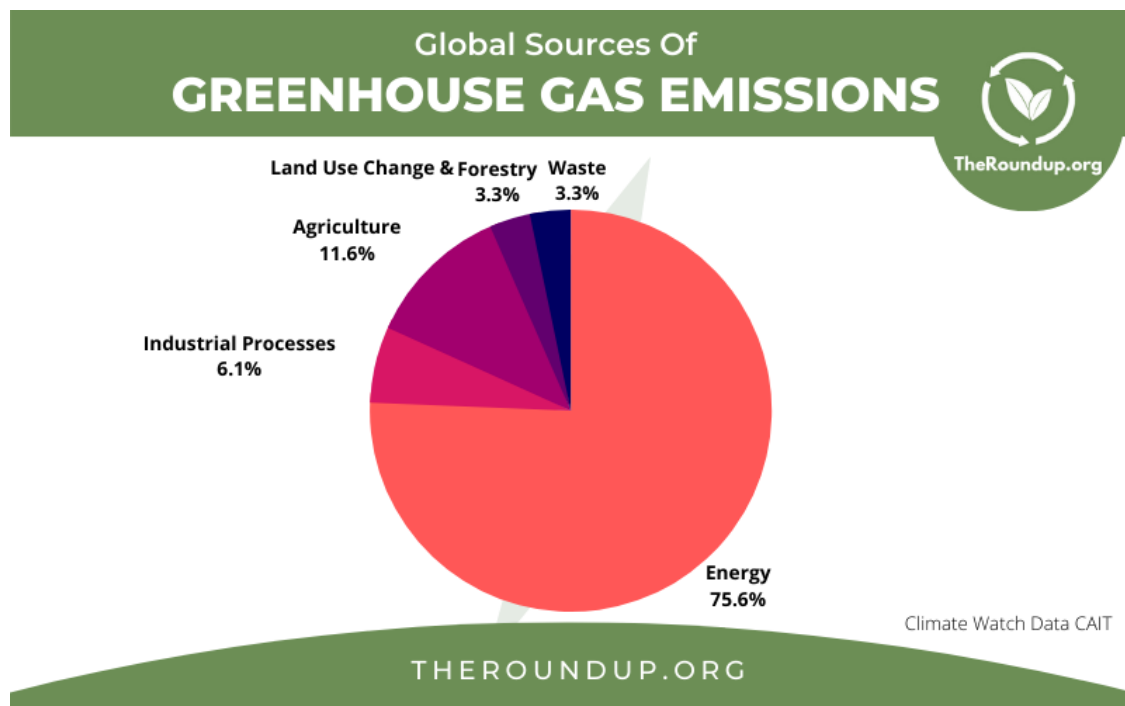


Figura 1.1: Global sources of greenhouse gas emissions. Source: theroundup.org

Addressing emission reduction is critical, as strict regulations on emissions and fuel efficiency aimed at mitigating the environmental impact of maritime activities are being implemented worldwide [2]. In the area of ships there are several activities to replace the proven diesel mechanical drives by new concepts. The triggers are firstly the ever increasing price of fossil fuels and the other a more stringent emission standard in so-called Sulphur Emission Control Areas

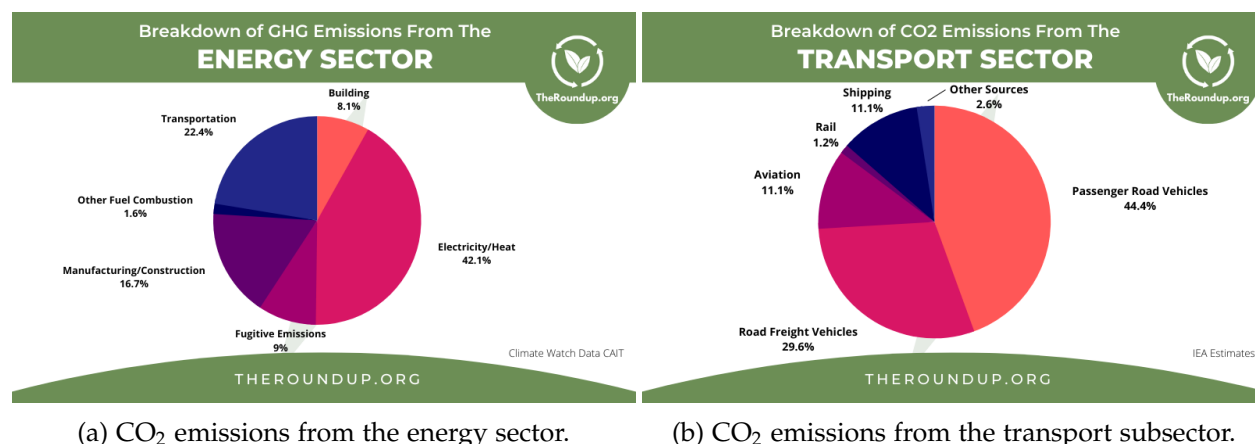


Figura 1.2: Breakdown of CO₂ emissions from the energy sector and the transport subsector. Source: theroundup.org

(SECA) from 1 January 2015. After that, only fuels may be used with a sulfur content of 0.1 percent in may coastal regions, which means additional costs for pushcase of fuel [2].

The International MARitime Organization (IMO) is implementing strategies to reduce the emissions from international shipping by establishing standards, imposing restrictions and providing incentives. The initial strategy envisages a reduction in total GHG emissions from international shipping by at least 50 % by 2050 compared to 2008. consistent with the Paris Agreement. IMO's current global standard for SO_x emissions is 0.5 % mass by mass (m/m) by 2025 per the International Convention for the Prevention of Pollution by Ships (MARPOL 73/78) Annex VI. Similarly, the emission limit for NO_x from engines is dependent on the type of the engine and the nominal engine speed. The global limit has been set to 14.4 g/kWh for engines with speeds less than 130 rev/min and 7.7 g/kWh for engines with speed greater than 2000 rev/min.

To comply with the standards and emissions reduction goals set by IMO, the maritime industry is looking for reduced and zero-emission technologies and approaches. The transition from traditional fossil fuel engines to zero-emissions technologies is challenging in a competitive market, where manufacturers are struggling to increase revenue and reduce production cost. The incentives to reduce emissions and improve the efficiency of equipment are motivating ship manufacturers to adopt zero-emission technologies. Fuel cells and energy storages (for example, batteries and supercapacitors) reduce GHG emissions and are the key enablers for the realization of low-emissions operation of marine vessels.

One promising approach is adopting electro-mobility technologies in maritime operations. In this context, electromobility can be implemented through various strategies [3], from hybrid propulsion systems to fully electric vessels [4]. Hybrid propulsion, in particular, combines the advantages of diesel engines with electric power systems, offering a flexible and efficient solution for reducing emissions without compromising performance [5]. The hybridization of propulsion systems relies on the separate or simultaneous use of different energy sources [1].

Several studies have examined hybrid propulsion systems. A marine hybrid propulsion system, focusing on vector control of the electric motor during different modes and verifying the control feasibility [6]. The optimization of hybrid propulsion system design for a tugboat has been explored, presenting a methodology that streamlines powertrain component sizing and control, minimizing costs for a specific operating profile [7]. A coordinated control strategy for a variable-speed hybrid tugboat have been presented to improve fuel economy. The proposed strategy,

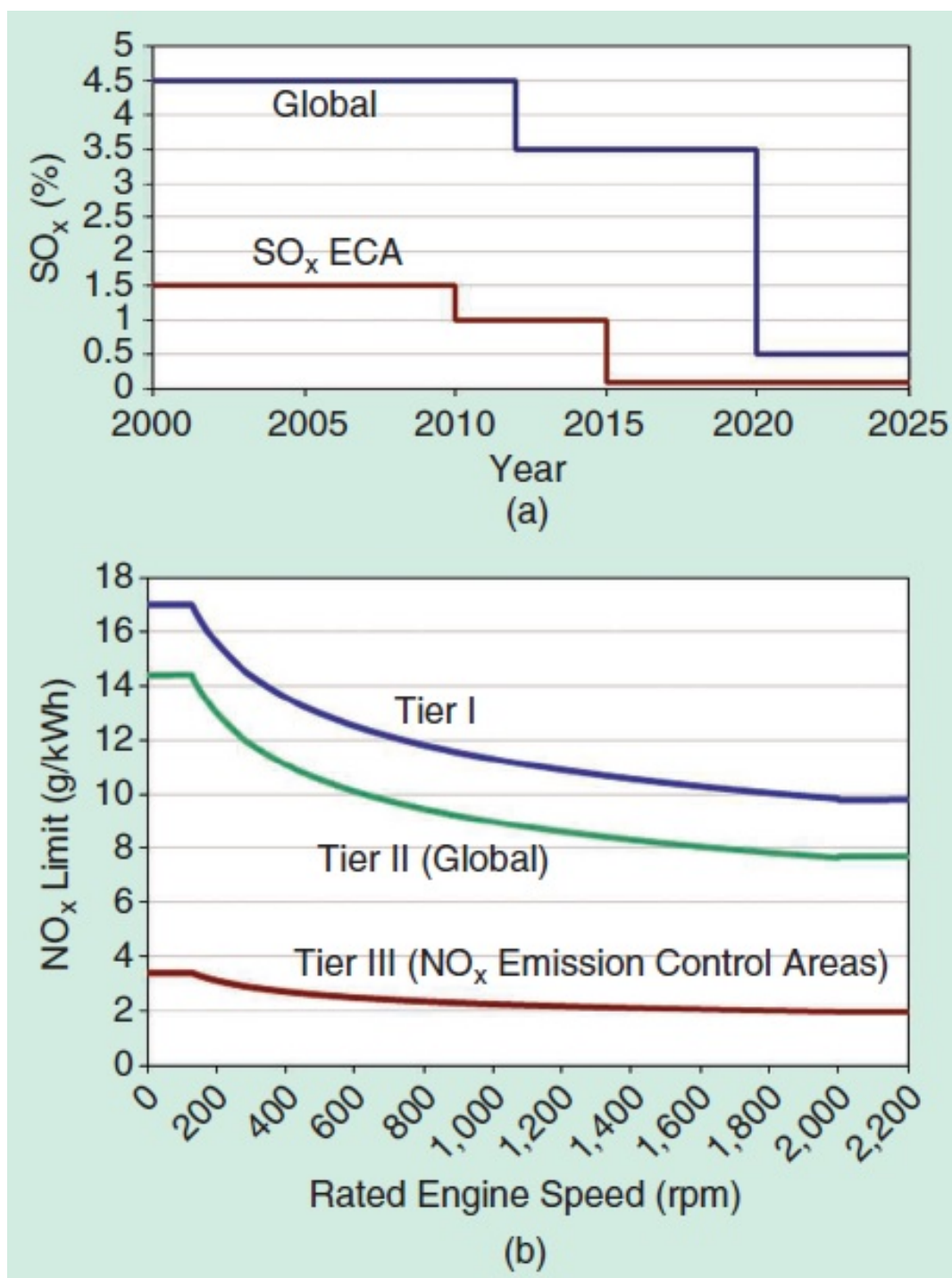


Figura 1.3: The MARPOL Annex VI emission limits for global and Emission Controlled Areas (ECAs perspective (a) SO_x and (b) NO_x. (Source: DieselNet

validated through simulations and a smallscale experimental testbed, showed reduced costs and lower CO₂ emissions [8].

Among vessel types, tugboats—used for towing and maneuvering large ships—are among the highest emitters per unit of energy due to their highly variable load profiles [3]. Tugboats

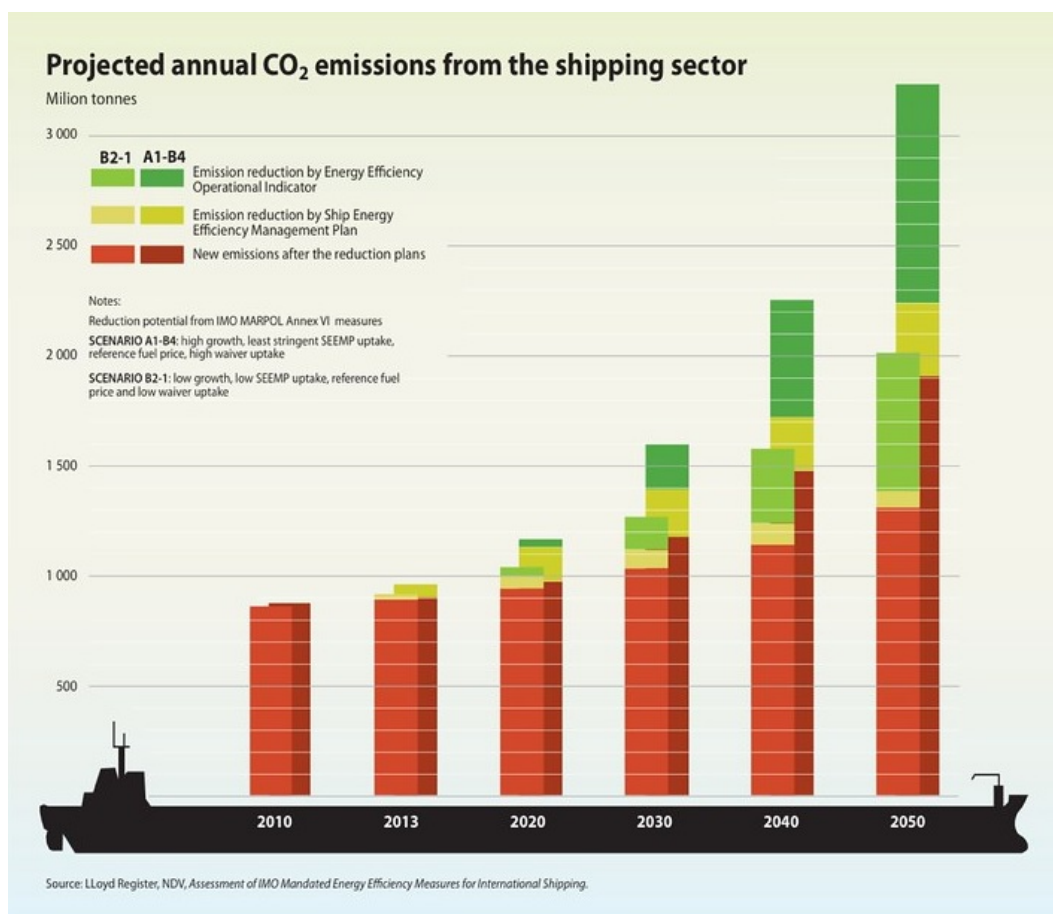


Figura 1.4: IMO greenhouse gas emissions strategy. Source: Lloyd Register, NOV, Assessment of IMO Mandated Energy Efficiency Measures for International Shipping

and ferries are ideal candidates for hybridization due to their operational profiles, which involve prolonged idling, low-speed maneuvering, and frequent speed changes that lead to inefficient fuel consumption [9].

This paper focuses on designing and sizing an energy storage system for a hybrid tugboat as a specific electro-mobility solution. Despite advancements in marine hybrid technologies, a standardized methodology for tugboat hybridization remains undefined [10]. The study presents a design methodology addressing parameters such as load profiles, power and energy demands, battery technology selection, and propulsion system optimization. Theoretical analysis is presented and simulation shows a emissions reduction while maintaining the robustness needed for towing and transit activities.

1.2. Challenges and Research Opportunities

1.3. Thesis Objectives and Outline

[1],

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- [2] Völker, Thorsten. "Hybrid Propulsion Concepts on Ships." 2013.